

अथ त्रयोदशोऽध्यायः ॥

ऋषिरुवाच ॥ १ ॥

एतत्ते कथितं भूप देवीमाहात्म्यमुत्तमम् ॥ २ ॥

एवम्प्रभावा सा देवी ययेदं धार्यते जगत् ।
विद्या तथैव क्रियते भगवद्विष्णुमायया ॥ ३ ॥

तया त्वमेष वैश्यश्च तथैवान्ये विवेकिनः ।
मोह्यन्ते मोहिताश्चैव मोहमेष्यन्ति चापरे ॥ ४ ॥

1-2. The R̥ṣi said : I have now narrated to you O King, this sublime poem on the glory of the Devī.

3. The Devī is endowed with such majestic power. By her this world is upheld. Knowledge is similarly conferred by her, the illusive power of Bhagavān Viṣṇu.

4. By her, you, this merchant and other men of discrimination, are being deluded; and others were deluded (in the past), and will be deluded (in the future).

तामुपैहि महाराज शरणं परमेश्वरीम् ।
आराधिता सैव नृणां भोगस्वर्गापवर्गदा ॥ ५ ॥

मार्कण्डेय उवाच ॥ ६ ॥

इति तस्य वचः श्रुत्वा सुरथः स नराधिपः ।
प्रणिपत्य महाभार्गं तमृषिं संशितव्रतम् ॥ ७ ॥

निर्विण्णोऽतिममत्वेन राज्यापहरणेन च ।
जगाम सद्यस्तपसे स च वैश्यो महामुने ॥ ८ ॥

सन्दर्शनार्थमम्बाया नदीपुलिनसंस्थितः ।
स च वैश्यस्तपस्तेपे देवीसूक्तं परं जपन् ॥ ९ ॥

5. O great King, take refuge in her, the supreme Īsvari. She indeed when worshipped bestows on men enjoyment, heaven and final release (from transmigration).

6-8. Mārkaṇḍeya said (to his disciple Bhāguri): O great sage, King Suratha who had become despondent consequent on his excessive attachment and the deprivation of his kingdom, and the merchant, having heard this speech prostrated before the illustrious Rṣi of severe penances and immediately repaired to perform austerities.

9. Both king and the merchant, in order to obtain a vision of Ambā, stationed themselves on the sand-bank of a river and practised penances, chanting the supreme Devī-sūkta (hymn to the Devī).

तौ तस्मिन् पुलिने देव्याः कृत्वा मूर्तिं महीमयीम् ।
अर्हणां चक्रतुस्तस्याः पुष्पधूपाग्नितर्पणैः ॥ १० ॥

निराहारौ यताहारौ तन्मनस्कौ समाहितौ ।
ददतुस्तौ बलिं चैव निजगात्रामृगुक्षितम् ॥ ११ ॥

एवं समाराधयतोस्त्रिभिर्वर्षैर्यतात्मनोः ।
परितुष्टा जगद्धात्री प्रत्यक्षं ग्राह चण्डिका ॥ १२ ॥

देव्युवाच ॥ १३ ॥

यत्प्राथ्यते त्वया भूय त्वया च कुलनन्दन ॥ १४ ॥

मत्तस्तत्प्राप्यतां सर्वं परितुष्टा ददामि तद् ॥ १५ ॥

10. Having made an earthen image of the Devi on the sands of the river, they both worshipped her with flowers, incense, fire and libation of water.

11. Now abstaining from food, and now restraining in their food, with their minds on her and with concentration, they both offered sacrifices sprinkled with blood drawn from their own bodies.

12. When they, with controlled minds propitiated her thus for three years, Caṇḍikā, the upholder of the world, was well pleased and spoke to them in visible form.

13-15. The Devi said : What you solicit, O King, and you, the delight of your family, receive all that from me. Well-pleased I bestow those to you both.

मार्कण्डेय उवाच ॥ १६ ॥

ततो वत्रे नृपो राज्यमविभ्रंश्यन्यजन्मनि ।

अत्र चैव निजं राज्यं हतशत्रुबलं बलात् ॥ १७ ॥

सोऽपि वैश्यस्ततो ज्ञानं वत्रे निर्विण्णमानसः ।

ममेत्यहमिति प्राज्ञः सङ्गविच्युतिकारकम् ॥ १८ ॥

देव्युवाच ॥ १९ ॥

स्वल्पैरहोभिर्नृपते स्वराज्यं प्राप्स्यते भवान् ॥ २० ॥

हत्वा रिपून्स्खलितं तव तत्र भविष्यति ॥ २१ ॥

16-17. Mārkaṇḍeya said: Then the King chose a kingdom, imperishable even in another life, and in this life itself, his own kingdom wherein the power of his enemies is destroyed by force.

18. Then the wise merchant also, whose mind was full of dispassion for the world, chose that knowledge which removes the attachment (in the form of) 'mine' and 'I'.

19-21. The Devī said: 'O King, after slaying your foes in a few days, you shall obtain your own kingdom and it shall last with you there.'

मृतश्च भूयः सम्प्राप्य जन्म देवाद्विवस्वतः ॥ २२ ॥

सावर्णिको नाम मनुर्भवान्भुवि भविष्यति ॥ २३ ॥

वैश्यवर्य त्वया यश्च वरोऽस्मत्तोऽभिवाञ्छितः ॥ २४ ॥

तं प्रयच्छामि संसिद्धयै तव ज्ञानं भविष्यति ॥ २५ ॥

मार्कण्डेय उवाच ॥ २६ ॥

इति दत्त्वा तयोर्देवी यथाभिलषितं वरम् ।

बभूवान्तर्हिता सद्यो भक्त्या ताभ्यामभिष्टुता ॥ २७ ॥

22-23. 'And when you are dead, you shall gain another birth from the Deva Vivasvat (Sun), and shall be a Manu on earth by name Sāvarṇi.

24-25. 'And O the best of merchants, I grant you the boon which you have desired of me. (Supreme) knowledge shall be yours, for your self-realisation.'

26-27. Mārkaṇḍeya said: Having thus granted them both the boon that each desired, the Devī disappeared forthwith, as they were extolling her with devotion.

एवं देव्या वरं लब्ध्वा सुरथः क्षत्रियर्षभः ।

सूर्याज्जन्म समासाद्य सावर्णिर्भविता मनुः ॥ २८ ॥

सावर्णिर्भविता मनुः क्लीं ओम् ॥ २९ ॥

इति श्रीमार्कण्डेयपुराणे सावर्णिके मन्वन्तरे देवीमाहात्म्ये
सुरथवैश्ययोर्वरप्रदानं नाम त्रयोदशोऽध्यायः ॥ १३ ॥

श्रीसप्तशतीदेवीमाहात्म्यं समाप्तम्

ओं तत् सत् ओम् ॥

28-29. Having thus gained the boon from the Devī, Suratha, the foremost of Kṣatriyas, shall obtain a new birth through Sūrya (and of his wife Savarnā), and shall be the Manu (eighth) named Sāvarni, shall be the Manu named Sāvarni.¹

Here ends the thirteenth chapter called 'The bestowing of boons to Suratha and Vais'ya' of Devī-māhātmya in Mārkaṇḍeyapurāṇa, during the period of Sāvarni, the Manu.

Here ends the Devī-Māhātmya of 700 Mantras.

OM TAT SAT OM.

¹ Repetition because of the end of the book.